

Oppo Find X9

The flagship that chooses balance over excess

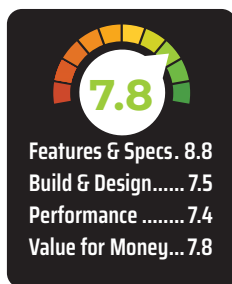
I have been saying this for some time now that 2025 was all about AI and cameras, with far less attention given to on-paper specifications. At the same time, the market has seen strong demand yet feels oddly fragmented. On one end, there's no shortage of compact phones, many of which arrive with clear compromises. On the other hand, there are Ultra models with large screens, bold designs and equally large price tags delivering excess where restraint might have been welcome. What's missing are options in between, phones that don't go overboard, yet refuse to cut corners on performance, display quality, features and, most importantly, the camera experience. That's exactly why I decided to review the Oppo Find X9.

Among the many big-name launches this year, the Find X9 has already managed to grab attention for its camera capabilities and its promise of being an all-rounder. But beyond the spec sheet and the initial hype, I wanted to understand something specific: how Oppo has actually tuned this phone, especially after the success of the Find X8. Has the brand played it safe, or has it refined its formula in ways that matter for everyday use?

So this time around, instead of rushing to conclusions, I spent time with the Find X9 to see how it fits into this oddly neglected space in the market. And here's my take.

DISPLAY

At this price point, you will find many phones that promise a great display, and



for me, the Oppo Find X9 comfortably sits near the top of that list. It comes with a 6.59-inch AMOLED panel featuring a 120Hz refresh rate and HDR10+ support. On paper, it looks interesting, but in real life, it has more to offer.

First off, the 6.59-inch panel hits a sweet spot that's becoming increasingly rare in the flagship segment. It's large enough to feel immersive while watching videos or browsing, yet compact enough to remain manageable for everyday use. Oppo has opted for a flat AMOLED panel with ultra-slim, symmetrical bezels, and it's a decision that pays off.

Brightness levels are strong too, offering excellent visibility indoors and outdoors, while OLED's deep blacks ensure excellent contrast for HDR content. In our testing, in manual mode, it comfortably crosses 1,300 nits, while

adaptive brightness can push well past that when needed (at 3,000 nits).

And what impressed me was how well the display is tuned. In our Calman test using the SpectraCal C6 colourimeter, we got an average Delta E of around 1, which is outstanding by smartphone standards. In real-world terms, colours look accurate, restrained, and mature. Skin tones appear natural, whites don't drift, and there's no artificial oversaturation trying to impress you in the first five seconds. Simply put, this display is built for people who care about photography, video and visual consistency.

PERFORMANCE

On paper, the Find X9 is clearly positioned as a serious performance flagship, and in day-to-day use, it largely delivers on that promise. Powered by MediaTek's Dimensity 9500, built on an advanced 3nm process, this is one of those phones that feels fast without constantly trying to prove it. Everyday tasks like scrolling through social media, jumping between apps, and editing photos on the go are handled with an ease that feels almost boring, and that's a compliment. Nothing stutters, nothing hesitates.

Where things get more interesting is gaming. Camera-centric phones often compromise here, but the Find X9 doesn't. In our testing, it managed consistent 120FPS gameplay in BGMI, even during extended sessions. Yes, the phone does warm up, as any performance-focused device will, but thermal management is clearly well optimised.

Benchmark numbers back this experience. The device scored an AnTuTu score of around 3.44 million, slightly ahead of the Vivo X300. In Geekbench 6, we got 3142 (single-core) and 9721 (multi-core), while in the PCMark's Work 3.0 test, the device scored 12,597.

That said, it's not flawless. During CPU throttling tests, the phone retained about 70 percent of its peak performance, which is decent but not